



# Summary of \$100M Leads

## Original book by Alex Hormozi

If there's one thing that separates thriving businesses from those that struggle, it's lead generation—the art of getting more people interested in what you're selling.

In *\$100M Leads*, serial entrepreneur Alex Hormozi, whose businesses generate \$200 million annually and over 20,000 leads daily, reveals his systematic approach to filling your customer pipeline. Hormozi argues there are only four ways to let people know about your business: warm outreach, cold outreach, free content, and paid ads. This guide explores his advice about leveraging these channels with lead magnets—free, high-quality products or services that get people engaged with your business. We'll also explain his strategies for scaling your lead generation tactics with help from others.

In our commentary, we explore alternative perspectives on advertising from leading marketing firms and experts like David Ogilvy (*Confessions of an Advertising Man*) and Seth Godin (*This is Marketing*).

---

This document is restricted to the personal use of the individual owner of the email account rakib.py+free@gmail.com (the "Subscriber"). No part of this document may be reproduced or distributed by any means other than for personal use of the Subscriber, nor shared with individuals other than the Subscriber, without prior written permission of Shortform Inc.

# 1-Page Summary

If there's just one thing you should focus on to take your business from surviving to thriving, it would be getting more *leads* (people interested in your offerings). In *\$100M Leads* (2023), business guru Alex Hormozi explains that leads are, by definition, the lifeblood of your business—without them, you'll never make a sale. By focusing intensively on lead generation, you can quickly multiply your revenue, reinvest it into getting more leads, and keep on growing.

Hormozi is a serial entrepreneur whose businesses earn \$200 million in annual revenue and, he says, get over 20,000 leads daily. He's also the author of *\$100M Offers*, in which he explains how to craft your core business offering. *\$100M Leads* builds on that wisdom: Hormozi packs it with marketing frameworks, best practices, and rules of thumb for getting more people interested in what you're selling.

In this guide, we'll detail Hormozi's approach to lead generation in three parts:

- **Leads and Lead Magnets**—what they are, why lead magnets work, and how to make one
- **How to Get More Leads**—how to market hard and smart, and how to get leads in four ways (warm outreach, content marketing, cold outreach, and paid ads)
- **How to Scale Your Marketing**—how to multiply your marketing efforts by using customers, employees, agencies, and affiliates to expand your reach

In our commentary, we compare and contrast Hormozi's methods with those of other marketing and sales experts, like David Ogilvy (*Confessions of an Advertising Man*) and Seth Godin (*This Is Marketing*). We also touch on other aspects of marketing, like sales pipelines and consumer psychology, that Hormozi doesn't cover.

(Shortform note: While Hormozi uses the term “advertising” to describe his lead generation methods, we'll call them “marketing.” Why? Marketing is a broad category of business practices that *discover, predict, and serve customer needs*. They include researching potential and target audiences, getting people interested in your business with online and offline advertising campaigns, managing public relations, and running brand accounts on social media. Advertising is narrower: It means *paying to place your messaging in a specific location* (like on a billboard or webpage). So although some of Hormozi's ideas directly involve advertising—like his advice on paid ads—they all fit into the larger category of marketing.)

---

## Leads and Lead Magnets

Hormozi writes that **a lead is someone you can reach out to**. Your Facebook friends are leads; your old college classmates are leads; your colleagues are leads; your email contacts are leads.

You don't want just leads, though—**you want leads who are interested in what you're selling**. Interested leads are more likely to become buying customers, fueling your business. But according to Hormozi, getting interested leads can be difficult in today's hypercompetitive business landscape. This section will cover his advice for surmounting this challenge by using a *lead magnet* to attract potential customers. We'll define lead magnets, explain why they work, and describe how to create them.

(Shortform note: Hormozi uses “leads” to refer to potential customers at any stage of the buying process, but other experts make finer distinctions. Salesforce defines leads as interested potential buyers and *switches to calling them “prospects”* once they've been “qualified” as likely buyers. Qualification involves assessing how interested a lead is (a little, or a lot?) as well as whether they can afford your product or

service. From there, you re-evaluate qualified prospects to determine which are the best “sales opportunities”—those with the highest likelihood of buying. The point is that, for businesses with lots of potential buyers, it pays to sift them finely and prioritize marketing to the best possibilities.)

### What Lead Magnets Are and How They Work

To get more leads, you need a lead magnet. Hormozi writes that **a lead magnet is a product or service, like an ebook or consultation, that solves a small but significant problem for your potential customers.** Businesses exist to solve problems for people, and the problem your lead magnet solves should point to a *larger* problem that your business’s core offer solves.

For instance, a life coach might use an ebook about building productivity habits to help people wrangle their to-do lists. In turn, that ebook would show them how much they still have to learn about getting stuff done, pointing them to the coach’s course about professional development or her one-on-one coaching calls.

(Shortform note: You can think of a lead magnet as an appetizer that comes before what Hormozi calls your “core offer” in *\$100M Offers*—the [high-value product or service](#) that’s central to your business and warrants a premium price (like a full-service weight loss program). To justify its price, a core offer needs to convince people that it’ll solve a serious problem they face, like the need to lose weight, with relatively little effort from them. A lead magnet turns people onto your core offer by solving a small facet of that serious problem, which demonstrates your expertise and the value you offer. In other words, it gives people a taste of the value you provide, and that makes them more likely to trust your core offer, too.)

By solving a problem for someone, your lead magnet gets them *interested* in your business. Someone who’s interested will more likely buy from you. In other words, **a good lead magnet increases your potential sales by increasing your volume of interested buyers.** It does this by providing so much value for free that people think to themselves, “If this is the free stuff, the paid stuff must be amazing.”

(Shortform note: A lead magnet may increase your potential sales, but the leads you get with it aren’t much use if you can’t sell well. This is why many marketing professionals typically consider prospecting (or getting leads) to be [the first part of a larger sales pipeline](#). A sales pipeline is a series of stages that moves a prospect from being a potential buyer to an actual customer. The later stages vary depending on whether you’re in business-to-business (B2B) or business-to-customer (B2C) sales, but they often involve conducting sales meetings, holding negotiations, and running email campaigns. Since Hormozi focuses just on generating leads, we’ll add related sales ideas throughout the guide.)

### How to Make a Lead Magnet

How do you ensure your lead magnet is valuable enough to attract interest? Hormozi says to **start with a precisely defined problem your leads face** (like lacking good productivity habits). Then, design a product or service that solves it and also makes the lead realize that they need your core offer too.

Hormozi writes that one effective way to do this is to **provide one key step of a multi-step solution**, like offering just the first module of a leadership course, to leave leads wanting more. Then, your core offer would be the whole paid course. Another option is to make a lead magnet that points out the symptoms of a larger problem. For example, a business consultant might give a free assessment of a startup team’s working practices that shows them how much better they could be performing—if they hire the consultant.

#### How to Solve Your Leads’ Problems

There are innumerable problems to solve in this world—so how do you know which problem you

should tackle? **Start by thinking about who you want to serve, then look for what problems they have.** In *This Is Marketing*, Seth Godin argues that a business [should focus on serving its core audience](#): the smallest viable group of people that can sustain the business's work. He says this shouldn't be a demographic group (which is the standard approach to defining a market) but a group with shared values that transcend demographic lines. Then, identify a problem that group has—which is often rooted in an unmet emotional need—and [create something of value](#) that solves it.

Say you want to serve people who value creating a fairer world. You identify that many such people like good food, but they don't like supporting exploitative agribusinesses. For instance, buying [name-brand chocolate](#) that depends on [child labor](#), slavery, and environmental degradation makes them feel bad, and they'd rather feel good. With your core audience (ethical foodies) and their problem (unethical chocolate) identified, the solution becomes clear: Make delicious, ethically sourced chocolate.

How would you make a lead magnet for this idea? First, narrow the problem: People want to feel good about the food they buy, but it's often hard to tell where foodstuffs come from. So, the smaller problem could be, "How can I tell whether something is ethical before I buy it?"

Then, you'd make a lead magnet that solves that problem. For example, it could explain what certifications to look for on packaging to be sure a product is ethical. In doing so, the lead magnet would point out that your business follows all the ethical practices it covers and, in turn, influence them to try your core offering (ethical chocolate).

Hormozi also recommends that when you're making your lead magnet, you should always use the following four tactics:

### 1) Use Multiple Formats

If you can, create a lead magnet that can take multiple formats. If it can be an ebook, a physical book, a webinar presentation, and more, that's great—it means people can consume it in their preferred format, increasing lead generation.

(Shortform note: What if you lack the technical skills to develop multiple formats? You have two options: Hire someone to create them for you, or teach yourself the necessary skills. If you choose the latter, Shortform has resources that can help—for instance, [Writing for Busy Readers](#) can help you craft effective ebooks. It teaches how to [convey essential information without unnecessary complexity](#). If you want to run a webinar, you might [read our master guide to public speaking](#) to learn how to prepare, practice, and deliver brilliant presentations.)

### 2) Test the Content

Hormozi says you should put most of your effort into making sure that your lead magnet's presentation hooks people well. So, test the parts of your magnet that leads see first: its name, headline, presentation (like the webpage leads find it on), and subheading.

(Shortform note: When it comes to testing, the tried-and-true approach of modern marketing is [A/B testing](#). To A/B test your lead magnet, create two versions of one of its aspects—like your headline or the landing page. Then, split your audience of leads into two groups of equal size, and show the first version to Group A and the second version to Group B. This will help you see which performs better. You can then use the winning version and continue testing other elements, gradually improving your lead magnet's effectiveness through data-driven decisions rather than guesswork.)

### 3) Build Goodwill

Hormozi recommends making your lead magnet so useful that people feel like they should have paid for it. This makes them feel indebted to you, which builds loyalty, and it'll drive them to pay for anything else you offer them.

(Shortform note: The psychology behind this approach [taps into the principle of reciprocity](#)—when you do something for someone, they'll naturally feel obligated to return the favor. In *Influence*, Robert Cialdini writes that we feel like we should reciprocate because [we evolved in close-knit communities](#) that relied on mutual cooperation to survive. So when you apply reciprocity in marketing, you're tapping into a deep feature of human nature, and it forms a powerful foundation for customer loyalty.)

### 4) Outshine Competitors

To persuade leads to choose *you*, make your lead magnet more worthwhile than competitors' paid alternatives. For example, leads should get more from your free ebook on productivity habits than from another life coach's paid productivity course.

(Shortform note: With markets as saturated as they are, it isn't easy to make free material that's better than the paid alternatives. But in *Blue Ocean Strategy*, W. Chan Kim and Renée Mauborgne argue that it's still possible to create new areas of demand by innovating valuable products that break away from existing markets. They recommend doing this by [stripping away all unnecessary features and making new ones](#) that are so good people can't help but be interested. When it comes to lead magnets, this might mean offering something that your leads can't find elsewhere, like a [custom spreadsheet implementation](#) of a tried-and-true productivity method.)

---

## How to Get More Leads

So far, we've looked at why you need interested leads and how lead magnets work. In this section, we'll turn to Hormozi's methods for finding leads and offering them your lead magnet. We'll start with his practical principles for marketing success—how to work so hard and smart at lead-getting that you can't fail. Then, we'll explore two categories of lead generation: private marketing (warm and cold outreach) and public marketing (free content and paid ads).

### How to Market Hard and Smart

How can you fool-proof your lead-getting efforts? According to Hormozi, all you have to do is work *hard*—by increasing the volume of actions you take—and *smart*—by making those actions more efficient whenever possible.

First, Hormozi writes, **the simplest way to succeed in marketing is to take a lot of actions**. This works because the more effort you put in, the more leads you'll attract—and the more leads you attract, the higher the chance that you'll get customers. Given this, Hormozi recommends following his "Rule of 100": Do 100 marketing actions every day for 100 consecutive days. This might mean making 100 cold calls, spending 100 minutes creating content, or investing \$100 in ads daily. Whatever you do, do it at high volume and do it consistently.

(Shortform note: The Rule of 100 might not work for every business. For one thing, 100 is a somewhat arbitrary number—100 marketing actions per day may not align with your resources and goals if you're a very small or very large company. But you can reap the same benefits by [making a massive action plan](#), a strategy from Tony Robbins that aligns your business goals with your values and emotions. Robbins

recommends that you set ambitious goals and then clarify how they serve your values and inspire you emotionally. This motivates you to fully commit to any massive action you need to undertake.)

**In addition to taking massive action, you need to take action efficiently.** According to Hormozi, this is because for any marketing action you take (like cold emailing), doing more of it becomes less efficient after a certain point. Say you've cold emailed 1,000 potential leads, and only 50 show interest in your business (a 1/20 conversion rate). More of the same action won't change that rate, but *smarter* action will. Smarter action comes down to experimenting with new approaches and testing to see which do a better job of getting leads interested. For instance, you might experiment with the wording in your emails to discover how to make them more effective, so the volume you send doesn't go to waste.

(Shortform note: Hormozi isn't alone in stressing the importance of experimenting, testing, and efficiency—in fact, they're key to the success of many Silicon Valley giants. In *Hacking Growth*, Sean Ellis and Morgan Brown explain that [iteratively testing changes to different aspects of your business](#) is a powerful, efficient way to skyrocket its growth. Testing lets you learn about how people interact with your marketing and your product or service by gathering data about who clicks on what, which subject lines get more opens, which features drive more user traffic, and so on. Then, you can tweak things according to the results of a test, incrementally improving your business. Over time, those little wins compound into massive growth.)

Now that you understand *how* to take action, let's talk about the different kinds of marketing actions you can take.

### Get Leads with Private Marketing

**Private marketing is marketing to people via direct, one-to-one communication.** You do this through channels like email, mail, direct messages, and phone calls. Because this form of marketing is more personal, it can be very effective and is a good way to start learning how to market, Hormozi says. Below, we'll cover two kinds of private marketing: warm outreach and cold outreach.

(Shortform note: The concept of one-to-one marketing dates back to 1993, when Don Peppers and Martha Rogers wrote *The One to One Future*, which introduced the idea that businesses could build direct, personal relationships with customers. Later, Seth Godin built on their ideas by emphasizing that customer permission is key to these relationships. In *Permission Marketing*, he writes that the old paradigm of intrusive advertisements, like TV commercials that interrupt the show, [doesn't work as well as it used to](#). People have grown smarter about advertising and now prefer less intrusive communication. "Permission marketing" works because it involves [advertising only to people who've opted in](#), such as those who've signed up to an email list.)

#### Reach Out to Warm Leads

**The simplest way to get leads is to reach out to people you know** (warm leads). These are people who've given you permission to contact them—your friends, family, followers, current customers, previous customers, and anyone else in your existing network. As Hormozi explains, warm leads already trust you to some degree. They're more likely to be interested in your business, and because of that, you might be able to skip the lead magnet and go straight to the core offer.

Hormozi says you should reach out to warm leads systematically. Make a list of everyone you know, and then reach out to 100 of them each day (recall Hormozi's "Rule of 100"). Do this until you exhaust your contact list. If someone doesn't respond to your first two or three outreach attempts (such as messages or calls), move on to the next lead.

(Shortform note: What if you can't follow Hormozi's Rule of 100 because you don't *have* 100 warm leads to

contact daily? One solution is to turn to influencers. The biggest social media influencers have millions of [followers who trust them](#)—even [more than they trust traditional advertising](#). In other words, they have millions of warm leads, and those leads are more likely to buy from brands they recommend. Working with an influencer can help you [increase people's awareness of your brand](#), build its authority, and inject some creativity into your marketing (since influencers tend to be at the forefront of cultural trends and opinions.)

**When you contact a warm lead, don't directly pitch your offer to them.** Instead, strike up a friendly conversation for a few minutes by asking how they're doing and listening actively. Once you've built rapport, ask if they know anyone who might need what you offer, framing it in terms of the problem you're solving for people and the value that solution provides. Hormozi writes that by not pressuring people directly, you make them feel more comfortable. That way, they'll have an easier time referring you to others or expressing their own interest (since they won't feel pressured to).

(Shortform note: If you aren't used to this kind of conversation, warm outreach can seem daunting. Learning proven communication methods can make it easier. One such method comes from [Think Faster, Talk Smarter](#), in which Matt Abrahams writes that you can [use a "what, why, how" structure](#) to lend your conversations logical and narrative coherence. To do so, first introduce *what* you're talking about, then tell *why* it's relevant to your listener. Lastly, explain *how* they can apply or make use of the information you've given them. Because [preparation increases confidence](#), learning this method—or any similar technique—will help warm outreach seem less daunting.)

#### Reach Out to Cold Leads

In contrast to warm outreach, **cold outreach means contacting people you *don't* know and trying to interest them in your business.** According to Hormozi, cold outreach can scale more easily, since there are more people you don't know than people you do.

However, cold outreach is a good deal harder because it requires you to overcome a few challenges: finding a way to contact people, getting them to pay attention to your message, and sparking their interest in your offer. Hormozi offers three key tips for accomplishing this:

- Use *list brokers*: businesses that sell email lists, often grouped by demographic (like residents of Atlanta, Georgia) or affinity (like dog lovers). Alternatively, you can manually find emails and other contact information by searching social media profiles.
- Before you contact a lead, research them and use what you find to personalize your approach. For instance, if you learn they're also a business owner, you might compliment their work in your message. Hormozi says this makes cold outreach feel a bit warmer.
- If a lead doesn't respond to your first message, follow up at least two to three times. If they still don't respond, move on to the next person. If someone does respond—for instance, by replying to your email—you've got an interested lead.

(Shortform note: When choosing list brokers, use your best judgment. In the past, the Federal Trade Commission (FTC) has argued that data brokers operate without proper transparency, [calling for legislation](#) to regulate how they gather and sell data. Advocates say this matters because without regulation, [brokers aren't limited in how they can use your data](#). Hormozi's second tip carries less risk—and because people are self-interested, [showing genuine interest](#) helps get you a positive response. But while personalization helps, people's buying wants and needs can change fast—so if you do need to follow up, [keep things straightforward and respectful](#). This makes it more likely a lead will see your business as caring, rather than pushy.)

#### Get Leads with Public Marketing

**Public marketing is advertising to many people all at once.** Because of this, it's less personal than private marketing: You have less chance of interesting any given lead. But, Hormozi says, it also scales better because you can reach far more people *en masse* than through one-on-one communication.

You can do public marketing with warm or cold leads, and it involves mostly online efforts—Hormozi specifically discusses how to do content marketing and how to run paid ads.

#### Post Content Online

According to Hormozi, **posting content to build an online audience is the best thing you can do to get more leads.** This is because it scales well: The more people who like and share your content, the more people it'll reach. In turn, some of *those* people's contacts will like and share it as well, spreading it further.

How do you get this cycle going and build a huge audience? Hormozi writes that **you just need to post tons of content that provides tons of value.** Freely giving useful content shows people that you have a lot to offer, which earns you their interest—and in time, their business. For instance, many fitness influencers post videos showing how they eat, how to do specific exercises with good form, and so on. Giving away this free content builds them an audience to whom they can later sell a supplement, a training program, or fitness merchandise.

(Shortform note: In 2025, some experts say that the old adage "[content is king](#)" remains true, with a few caveats. For one, you may have to do more than post a lot of useful content to succeed. With [the rise of mass-produced AI content](#), standing out from the crowd requires more work. Marketers are increasingly using data to understand audience interests and values, then tailoring their brand storytelling around those insights. There's also an ongoing shift toward visual and video content, since attention spans are shorter than ever—it's quicker and easier to watch a video than read a text post. Following these strategies as well as Hormozi's can help you make it in the competitive world of content.)

Before you start posting content, you need to know how to make it. Hormozi writes that **every piece of content should do three things: grab interest, keep interest, and satisfy interest.**

**Grab interest:** Get people's attention by using topics they're interested in, and tailor the content format to the platform (videos on YouTube, text on LinkedIn, etc.). People will look at stuff they already like in formats they already like, so make more of that—don't reinvent the wheel.

**Keep interest:** Make people curious by using unresolved questions and storytelling—like how a good novel keeps you reading with cliffhangers. People who want to know what happens next will keep paying attention.

**Satisfy interest:** Deliver on your hook, making people feel rewarded for giving you their attention. This completes the "loop" that good content puts people in, encouraging them to behave the same way again when they see more of your content.

For instance, say you're a lifestyle influencer. You might: 1) grab interest by making an Instagram reel about a personal breakthrough you had with your morning routine, 2) keep interest by saying you'll explain the steps you took to get there, and 3) satisfy interest by telling the full story of how you found your perfect morning routine.

Hormozi says that your audience decides if they've been rewarded, not you. **When your content is consistently rewarding, your followers become more likely to buy from you and to share your content,** which helps your audience grow. Every person you add to your audience is a lead that you can reach out to.

## Habits, Hooks, and Human Nature

While he doesn't explain it as such, Hormozi's approach to content creation is basically a way of exploiting people's tendency to do things by habit. In *The Power of Habit*, Charles Duhigg writes that habits are unconscious, automatic behaviors that are **composed of a cue, a routine, and a reward**. The three elements of this "habit loop" mirror the three things Hormozi says content should do:

- **The cue** grabs your attention and pulls you toward some action, like eating a cookie or consuming a piece of content.
- **The routine** is the automatic pattern Hormozi's second step is meant to drive. If you do a good job keeping interest, people will default into an automatic pattern of consuming your content (just like we all sometimes mindlessly eat cookies).
- **The reward** completes the habit loop. When you reach the reward, **the link between cue, routine, and final satisfaction is reinforced in your brain**, further automating the habit.

Duhigg also acknowledges the role habits play in advertising. He writes that **advertisers deliberately exploit your brain's tendency** to default into automatic patterns by gathering data about you, then tailoring ads to hook your attention and get you to buy. This is something like what Hormozi recommends doing, though he emphasizes the power of giving away free, useful content without expecting anything in return.

Meanwhile, Nir Eyal (*Hooked*) discusses the habit loop as a tool to get people *hooked* on your product or service. He uses the terms *trigger*, *action*, and *reward*, and he adds a fourth—*investment*—which refers to how **people start to identify with things they do repeatedly**. If you follow Hormozi's advice and make consistently rewarding content, you may get people invested in your personal brand and business. Think of fandoms: Millions of people identify with their favorite authors, musicians, or influencers, and they're invested in continuing to follow those people's activities.

## Run Paid Ads Online

**Hormozi's last method for getting leads is to use paid ads.** This means crafting and running multimedia advertisements (using text, images, and video) on online platforms like Instagram or YouTube. These platforms already have huge built-in audiences, and you pay the platform to show your ads to those people.

Hormozi writes that unlike his earlier volume-focused methods, the trick with ads is to **focus on cost-efficiency—ads need to provide a good return on your investment**. You have to spend money to run ads, and many of them will fail. For this reason, they don't need to be perfect. What matters more is speed: Rapidly create multiple workable ads at once, test them out, and double down on the ones that work (while cutting those that fail). This way, you'll lose some money but make back more in the long run.

## Is Efficiency Always the Goal?

Not all digital marketers agree with Hormozi that speed is the best approach. Instead of rapidly creating ads and cutting the losers, some agencies systematically test the different aspects of an ad. They **change one thing at a time, measure the effect it has**, and keep the good changes to incrementally improve their marketing materials (like emails or landing pages). Other experts **recommend pre-testing ads with control groups** to see if they work well or not.

The main difference between these approaches comes down to risk aversion. Hormozi is willing to lose money on many ads to find the one that works—which is fine for smaller, faster-moving operations (his audience is mostly small entrepreneurs). But for bigger businesses spending lots of money on major ad campaigns, his approach may risk too much loss. Larger firms don't want to waste millions on bad ads. For this reason, they may take a somewhat slower but more systematic approach, [using trial and error to develop effective marketing that they know works](#) before they pour money into sending it out.

So, how do you run ads efficiently? Hormozi explains three basic steps:

**Step #1: Choose the right platform.** Look at major social media sites like Instagram, YouTube, and Twitter, all of which have massive existing audiences (everyone with an account). Hormozi advises starting with a platform that has plenty of the sort of people you want to reach (like beauty consumers on Instagram).

**Step #2: Target the right audience.** A platform's targeting tools are basically filters that you use to narrow your search for the right people, much like the filters you use while shopping online. According to Hormozi, the "right people"—your target audience—are people you think are likely to be interested in your business.

Most targeting tools use demographic filters, like age, income level, and interests. Use these filters to reduce the platform's large audience to only the people you want your ad to reach. For example, if you're advertising yoga classes for the elderly on Facebook, you'd use filters that target people over 60 who've shown interest in yoga and can afford your classes.

If you don't want to do this manually, Hormozi says that most platforms will make you a "lookalike audience," or an audience that shares demographic similarities with a list of contacts you provide. Make that list using all the lead contacts you have from warm outreach, content marketing, and cold outreach. This way, the people who see your ads will be similar to your already interested leads.

(Shortform note: The platforms and demographic targeting tools Hormozi discusses are the major players of [surveillance capitalism](#)—a form of business where big platforms gather data about users, make predictions about their behavior (like buying habits), and sell that data to advertisers. In [The Age of Surveillance Capitalism](#), Shoshana Zuboff argues that [this practice began with Google](#), which realized it could collect users' search data to make educated guesses about their habits, preferences, and future actions. Zuboff also writes that [surveillance capitalism endangers democracy](#) by undermining people's privacy, autonomy, and social empathy. If this concerns you, you could stick to Hormozi's other ways of getting leads.)

**Step #3: Make your ads.** After you've targeted the right audience on the right platform, you need to craft effective ads. Drawing on the principles of marketing titan David Ogilvy, Hormozi breaks ads down into three components:

- **Grab their attention:** Immediately signal to the viewer that your ad concerns them in some way. For instance, you can appeal to their identity ("Cat owners...") and location ("...in Los Angeles").
- **Offer them value:** Convince people they should be interested in what you're offering (lead magnet or core offer) by playing up its benefits and playing down the work involved in reaping them.
- **Tell them to act:** Lastly, tell people exactly what to do next. Make it simple and specific, like "Click this button." Ideally, Hormozi says, you should direct them to a webpage that lets them enter their email address in exchange for your lead magnet.

### More Tips for Effective Ads

As Hormozi mentions, many of the advertising ideas he shares come from the principles of experts like David Ogilvy. In *Confessions of an Advertising Man*, Ogilvy offers suggestions that complement Hormozi's explanation of how to advertise:

- When it comes to grabbing attention, Ogilvy argues that [any ad's headline should be a complete advertisement](#) in itself.
- He says advertisements should be [honest, interesting, and informational](#), ideally featuring the brand name somewhere prominent.
- Instead of emphasizing value directly, Ogilvy says the body of an ad should contain as much relevant product info as possible—like the features and specifications of a laptop—communicated in plain, conversational language.
- As for calls-to-action, Ogilvy worked in the 20th century when things moved more slowly, and he doesn't advise urging people to take immediate action. Instead, he writes that ads should spark lasting curiosity (perhaps by using creative images) that makes people want to investigate further.

---

## How to Scale Your Marketing

We've covered Hormozi's four marketing methods; now, let's look at how to scale them. According to Hormozi, **you can't scale on your own because one person can only do so much marketing**. When you've done all you can, it's time to get help—and there are four kinds of entities who can increase your business's reach: your customers, your employees, marketing firms, and business partners.

### Scale With People: Customers and Employees

First, **you can rely on happy customers to naturally spread the word about your business**. People who've bought from you and thought your product or service was excellent will say so, telling friends and family about it. To earn good word of mouth, just give people a fantastic experience being your customer—provide them with a great product and treat them well.

(Shortform note: Research supports Hormozi's assertion that word of mouth is a good scaling strategy. Word-of-mouth referrals [tend to spread far and to keep spreading](#) for a long time, which generates long-lasting effects for the money spent to earn them. Plus, 92% of consumers [trust recommendations from friends and family](#) more than ads.)

**You can also hire employees to help with marketing**. To do this effectively, Hormozi says, you should clearly document your marketing processes (what you do that works for you), give new employees a hands-on demonstration of how to implement your marketing methods, and ask them to do the exact same thing. This ensures that your employees will get results similar to yours.

(Shortform note: Other experts agree with Hormozi that if you decide to hire employees, you should [document your processes carefully](#). Good documentation reduces errors, saves time, and ensures consistency across your team, since anyone can reference it if they're feeling stuck or forgot how to do something. This leads to better results and higher satisfaction for both your employees and your customers

(because a well-run business creates more value). You don't have to stop at documenting your marketing methods; documenting all your important business processes can help your team work more smoothly. To accomplish this, create checklists, written tutorials, or videos that outline how to complete essential tasks.)

### Scale With Businesses: Marketing Firms and Affiliate Partners

Beyond using customers and employees, **you can pay marketing firms to teach you about how they advertise**. Hormozi says you should tell them upfront that you want to learn their methods, then offer to pay them to teach you. This way, you avoid becoming dependent on an outside business for your marketing success, and you can also train your employees to do what you learn.

(Shortform note: Here, Hormozi's approach [strikes a balance between outsourcing your marketing and developing a solid in-house team](#). Both have benefits: Outsourcing gives you faster access to more expertise, while building your own team ensures people have a deep understanding of your business and gives you more control over strategy. Following Hormozi's advice, you'll gain all of the benefits and avoid the downsides too.)

Lastly, **you can partner with other businesses and entrepreneurs to promote your business to their audiences**. Think *influencer marketing*—not everyone you affiliate with will be an influencer, but they're a powerful way to get your business in front of more eyeballs fast. You can collaborate with anyone who has an audience, though; the affiliate just sends their audience your way (like with a sponsored post or video), and you pay them for every lead that you successfully gain through their outreach.

(Shortform note: In 2025, some marketing experts have [begun to combine traditional affiliate marketing](#) (where you pay another business to advocate for yours) with influencer marketing (where you pay a person with a big following to do the same). With influencers driving nearly \$10 billion in annual business and engaging around 50% of Gen Z, partnering with them is becoming more important. It's also affordable, costing 20-30% less per customer than brand content that you produce in-house.)

## Exercise: Design a Lead Magnet

Hormozi writes that a strong lead magnet can get you more leads in any marketing channel. Practice creating a lead magnet that solves a small, significant problem and points people toward your larger solution.

What major problem does your main product or service solve for customers? Be specific about the outcome it helps people achieve.

What smaller, related problem do your potential customers face that you could solve in a single resource (ebook, checklist, video, etc.)? This should be something that naturally leads them to realize they need your core offer, like how a free training webinar leads to a full training program.

Describe exactly what you'll create to solve this smaller problem. Will it be a guide, template, checklist, video tutorial, or something else? What specific value will it provide?

Think through how your lead magnet will make people realize they need your main product or service. What will they discover about their larger problem after consuming it?

Based on Hormozi's standard that your lead magnet should be more worthwhile than paid alternatives, what paid resources currently exist that solve this same problem? How will yours be better?